CORPUS CHRISTI AND THE HOLY EUCHARIST

O BREAD OF HEAVEN

TYNEMOUTH 88.88.88. H. F. HEMY 1818-88 (R.R.T.)

2. O food of life, Thou Who dost give
The pledge of immortality;
I live, no 'tis not I that live;
God gives me life, God lives in me:
He feeds my soul, He guides my ways,
And every grief with joy repays.

3. O Bond of love, that dost unite
The servant to his living Lord;
Could I dare live, and not requite
Such love, - then death were meet reward:
I cannot live unless to prove
Some love for such unmeasur'd love.

4. Beloved Lord, in heaven above,
There, Jesus, thou awaitest me;
To gaze on thee with changeless love;
Yes, thus I hope, thus shall it be:
For how can he deny me heaven
Who here on earth himself hath given?

[ST. ALPHONSUS, 1696-1787. TR. E. VAUGHAN, C.SS.R, 1827-1908]